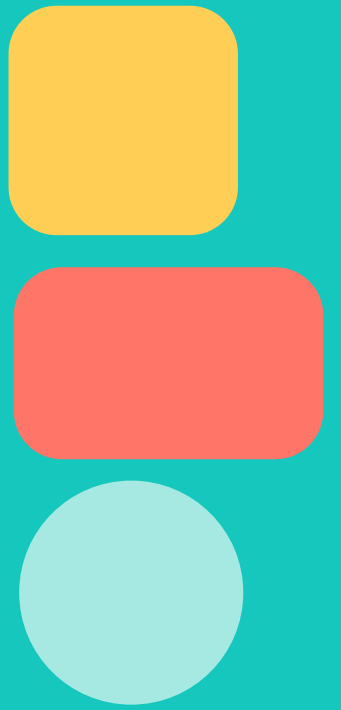
INTERNATIONAL | CREATIVE SAAS

ONE BRIEF.
FIVE ASSETS.

Creative Acquisition Experiment | Campaign, Analytics & Results

A product-led acquisition case for non-designers and small teams. The analysis links creative acquisition to the activation moment - exporting or sharing a first useful design - and then to paid upgrade economics.



CREATIVE TEST

ACTIVATION

UNIT ECONOMICS

PREPARED BY

SHAKIR HOSSAIN TALHA

Digital Marketer | Campaign Analytics & Results

CASE DATE / 25 February 2026

Requested portfolio date label; campaign outcomes below are simulated examples, not Canva data.

01 / THE CREATIVE THESIS

Sell the outcome, not the toolbar

THE HYPOTHESIS

A feature list can describe a tool; a finished outcome lets a prospect picture what they could make. Lead with the useful result, then remove the first-design friction.

PRIMARY BUSINESS OUTCOME

Acquire activated, retained creators at a sustainable payback - not just create free accounts.

AUDIENCE / JOB / MOMENT

01

MAKER

Solo creator / freelancer

Needs fast, credible content production and reusable systems.

02

GROWER

Small-business operator

Needs on-brand assets across channels without a full design team.

03

TEAM

Marketing or education team

Needs consistency, collaboration and repeatable workflows.

CAMPAIGN IDEA

ONE BRIEF. FIVE ASSETS.

02 / ASSET SYSTEM

Three concepts, three different jobs

1

OUTPUT-FIRST

From blank page to campaign kit

Split-screen before/after; show the finished outputs and then reveal the workflow.

2

USE-CASE

Launch a small business in an afternoon

A creator-led walkthrough of a real brief, templates and brand consistency.

3

TEAM-PROOF

One brand, many contributors

Show collaboration and brand controls; avoid exaggerated time-saved claims unless measured.

CHANNEL PORTFOLIO

Meta Reels / creator ads	25%		Output-first vertical clips; test first-frame and use case.
YouTube / video	20%		Tutorial and comparison content; optimise to high-intent visits.
Search intent	25%		Capture explicit template and design workflow intent.
Lifecycle / retargeting	20%		Nudge signed-up non-activators to first export; then evaluate paid upgrade.
Experiment reserve	10%		Landing page, onboarding and value-moment tests.

SPEND MODEL

USD 12,000 / 30-day planning scenario | Synthetic acquisition model. Currency is USD for an international SaaS scenario; it is not Canva's budget or actual performance.

03 / INSTRUMENTATION

The value moment is the first export

01	02	03	04	05	06
Impressions	Clicks	Landing sessions	Sign-ups	First export	Paid upgrades
2,000,000	24,000	21,600	5,400	3,780	270

EVENT MAP

- landing_view + utm_content
- sign_up_completed
- template_opened / design_created
- first_export / share_completed
- upgrade_view / checkout_started
- subscription_started + plan + value
- week-4 retained active creator

CORE METRIC PANEL

CTR	1.20%
Sign-up rate	25% of sessions
Activation	70% of sign-ups
Paid / activated	7.1%
Paid CAC	$44.44
Modeled GP LTV:CAC	1.44:1*

MEASUREMENT GUARDRAILS

Separate source → sign-up → first export → paid upgrade. Join cohorts by user ID only where privacy and consent rules allow. Use consistent UTMs and deduplicate events. Do not optimise to sign-up until activation and paid conversion are understood.

For subscription products, report cohort retention, contribution margin and payback; first-month revenue/spend alone is incomplete.

04 / RESULTS DASHBOARD

SIMULATED SCENARIO

Illustrative campaign readout

SPEND	IMPRESSION	RESULT	COST / RESULT
$12.0k	2.00M	270 paid upgrades	$44.44

FUNNEL TABLE

Impressions	2,000,000
Clicks	24,000
Landing sessions	21,600
Sign-ups	5,400
First export	3,780
Paid upgrades	270

RATE READOUT

CTR 1.20%



Session → primary action 1.25%



SYNTHETIC DEMO DATA. Assumes $10 monthly net revenue per paying user, 8-month expected paid life, and 80% gross margin: revenue LTV $80, gross-profit LTV $64, modelled GP LTV:CAC = 1.44:1. Actual pricing, retention and margins are not asserted. First-month revenue/spend = 0.225x and is not full LTV ROAS.

ANALYST READ

Acquire activated, retained creators at a sustainable payback - not just create free accounts. The next decision should be driven by verified downstream quality, not a single platform metric.

05 / DECISION SYSTEM

What to stop, fix, scale and learn

SIMULATED EXPERIMENT READOUT

A / Feature-list ad	**24% sign-up rate; 60% activation**	Communicates breadth but leaves the first job unclear.
B / Finished-output ad	**25% sign-up rate; 70% activation**	Illustrative activation advantage; confirm across audience and use case.
C / Workflow tutorial	**Lower CTR, higher first-export rate**	Consider as a retargeting or high-intent asset, not only a prospecting ad.

DECISION QUEUE

STOP	Optimising to sign-up if the account never creates or exports a design.
FIX	Onboarding gap between template click, design creation and first export.
SCALE	Only when activated-user CAC and paid-cohort retention meet the payback guardrail.
LEARN	Estimate cohort payback by market, plan, use case and creator source; compare brand vs direct response.

90-DAY MILESTONE

Scale cohorts with credible paid conversion and retention; run holdout or incrementality test.

06 / RESEARCH NOTES

Evidence behind the experiment

SOURCE 01

Canva - 2025 in review

https://www.canva.com/newsroom/news/canva-2025-wrap/

Public company framing and stated community growth.

SOURCE 02

Canva - State of Marketing & AI

https://www.canva.com/newsroom/news/marketing-ai-report/

Survey-based context on creative and AI workflows; not a causal performance guarantee.

SOURCE 03

Canva - Visual Economy Report

https://www.canva.com/newsroom/news/visual-economy-report/

Company-published research on visual communication and consistency.

SOURCE 04

Meta Blueprint - A/B and lift tests

https://www.facebookblueprint.com/student/path/219763-ab-test-conversion-brand-lift-course

Test design and evaluation concepts.

SOURCE 05

Google Analytics - Ecommerce / event measurement

https://support.google.com/analytics/answer/12200568?hl=en

Events need deliberate implementation for meaningful reporting.

PORTFOLIO CASE / AUTHOR

SHAKIR HOSSAIN TALHA

Digital Marketer | Campaign Analytics & Results

SIGNATURE DATE / 25 February 2026

Simulated campaign data is not Canva performance. Signature is stylized text, not a verified signature.

DECORATIVE SIGNATURE

Shakir